More Advanced Quotations

" Types of Citations"

A. Narrative MLA-Style In-Text Citations:

1. According to Smith, the impact of climate change on polar ice caps is alarming (225).
2. As Johnson argues, the economic downturn significantly influenced consumer spending habits (45-47).
3. In her study, Brown highlights the correlation between sleep deprivation and cognitive decline (82).

B. Parenthetical MLA-Style In-Text Citations:

1. The rapid growth of technology has reshaped communication patterns (Jones 104).
2. Many scientists emphasize the importance of biodiversity conservation (Miller et al. 37).
3. The novel explores themes of identity and self-discovery (García Márquez 213).

Quotation Variations:

1. Verb and Comma (Most Common):

Explanation: This is the most common way to integrate a quotation. The quoted material is introduced with a verb (such as "said," "explained," or "shouted") followed by a comma. It is straightforward and commonly used in academic and casual writing. Ensure that the quoted material fits seamlessly into the structure of your sentence.

Ex.

1) The object of Twain's ridicule shifts from American conmen to the citizens who enable their success when the undertaker declares, "**A**ll you've got to do is just be ca'am and stack it up—they'll stand the racket" (353).
2) He reassured us, "**Y**ou can always count on me."

Practice: P = notes (do not forget punctuation)

a. The author _____ "**S**ome things are better left unsaid."

2. Introductory Phrase:

Explanation: The quotation is introduced with a phrase, often providing context or attribution. The introductory phrase can be at the beginning or in the middle of the sentence. This structure adds variety to writing and allows for smoother integration of quotes. Ensure the introductory phrase flows smoothly with the rest of your sentence.

Ex.

1) Though Vonnegut declares that jokes function by "hooking people with little barbless hooks and letting them off again" (Fates 185), I would contend that this and most of his other humor operates in a significantly different, even antithetical, way. [Also #6 type]
2) Despite early skepticism, the project manager affirms, "We have exceeded our targets." [Also #1 type]

Practice: In the preface (do not forget punctuation)

a. _____the researcher asserts, "This study aims to redefine traditional notions of leadership." [Also #1 type]

3. Subordination using "That":

Explanation: The quoted material is subordinated using the word "that." This type is often used to integrate quotes into a sentence without breaking its flow. Ensure that "that" is appropriate for the context, and the quoted material is an integral part of the sentence's structure.

Ex.

1) Anthropologist Mary Douglas's contention that "**l**aughter is a unique bodily eruption which is always to be taken as a communication" (86) suggests that a laugh can be interpreted as a text.
2) The scientist's discovery indicates that "**n**ew possibilities in renewable energy may be on the horizon."

Practice: (do not forget punctuation)

a. The report argues _____"**e**ducational reforms are necessary for future success."

4. Introduction and Colon:

Explanation: The quotation is introduced with a complete sentence, followed by a colon. This type is effective for emphasizing or elaborating on the quoted material. The introduction sets the stage for the quote, providing a clear lead-in. Ensure that the introductory sentence and the quoted material are logically connected.

Ex.

1) Charlie Chaplin describes his humor as having primarily realist effect on its audience: "**I** make them conscious of the reality of life. 'You think this is it, don't you?' I say. 'Well, it isn't, but this is—see?' And then they laugh" (qtd. in Eastman 273).
2) The professor highlighted an essential point: "**U**nderstanding the basics is crucial before delving into advanced topics."

Practice: (do not forget punctuation)

a. The CEO shared valuable advice__ "**S**etting clear goals is the first step to success."

5. Interrupted Quotation (Less Common):

Explanation: The quote is interrupted by the author's own words, providing context or explanation within the quotation. This technique is less common and should be used judiciously. Ensure that the interruption enhances understanding and doesn't disrupt the flow of the quote.

Ex.

1) Joking about money has been one way the culture has grappled with its greedy tendencies. "At our worst," the critic Louis Kronenberger has expounded, "**w**e have made humor the handle of our acquisitiveness, a trick way of getting our foot in the door" (163).

6. Short Quotation (Few Words as Part of Your Own Sentence):

Explanation: A short quote, usually just a few words, is seamlessly integrated into the author's own sentence. This type is suitable for emphasizing key points or phrases from the source material. Ensure that the short quote enhances your sentence's meaning and is properly punctuated.

Ex.

1) In "Where I Lived, and What I Lived For," Thoreau reflects that his retreat to the woods around Walden Pond was motivated by his desire "to live deliberately" and to face only "the essential facts of life" (36).

Practice: Q = quality over quantity (do not forget punctuation)

a. In the workshop, the instructor emphasized the mantra, "_____"

7. Single Word Quotation (One or Two Words Max):

Explanation: Single words or very short phrases from the source are enclosed in quotation marks and integrated into the author's sentence. This technique is useful when emphasizing specific terms or concepts. Ensure that the single word quote is impactful and adds value to your sentence.

Ex.

1) Thoreau argues that people blindly accept "shams and delusions" as the "soundest truths," while regarding reality as "fabulous" (26).
2) The artist described the painting as "captivating."

Practice: Q = perseverance (do not forget punctuation)

3) The mentor emphasized the importance of "_____"